

The Coca-Cola Company

1Q24 Earnings Prep

We are below the Street for 1Q top line and profitability.

We think it has been well telegraphed that 1Q volumes will be light for KO given several timing dynamics - but looking past 1Q specifically, KO's growth profile and outlook seem on track. That said, it has been somewhat quiet on KO heading into tomorrow's print, with the key question among the investment community seemingly on what can serve as a catalyst for shares.

Current Consensus Expectations

---- 1Q24 ----

- 1Q24 EPS: \$0.70 [\$0.68-\$0.71 range, Barclays = \$0.69]
- 1Q24 sales growth: +0.0% [-1.6% to +1.7% range, Barclays = -1.4%, +4.5% organic]

---- 2024 ----

- 2024 EPS: \$2.81 [\$2.80-\$2.83 range, Barclays = \$2.81]
- 2024 sales growth: -0.1% [-1.6% to +1.2% range, Barclays = -0.5%, +6.7% organic]

---- 2025 ----

- 2025 EPS: \$3.00 [\$2.87-\$3.09 range, Barclays = \$3.00]
- 2025 sales growth: +4.9% [Barclays = +5.2%, +6.2% organic]

Source: Consensus figures from Bloomberg

Our Thoughts

We sense there's broad-based confidence in KO's top-line outlook among the investment community (i.e. we hear limited pushback to the notion of that KO can sustainably grow its top line in at least the top half of its +4-6% medium-term algorithm). But what we think could still be under-appreciated is the operating leverage and improved return profile that comes along more consistently with that growth (see [Proof is in the P&L](#), 01/18/24). While we admittedly struggle to think of a specific catalyst for shares in the near term, we would argue the quality of the fundamental picture here is supportive of relative valuation more in line with other best-in-class CPG peers (e.g. PG) and reiterate our Overweight.

For 1Q, we look for total company organic sales to be up +4.5% (+5.5% selling day adjusted) with all the growth attributable to price/mix (+6.4%) – meanwhile, concentrate volumes are down -1.9%, which includes a 1-point headwind each from one less selling day in the quarter and the Middle East conflict. And recall, KO's 4Q23 benefited from some stocking up in certain regions (namely Latin America and EMEA) that we expect to unwind in 1Q24, serving as another ~1.3-point headwind to 1Q24 volumes. Our organic top-line outlook is largely unchanged vs. how we thought about it coming out of the 4Q print, with the exception of having raised Asia Pacific's 1Q price/mix to +3.5% earlier in April. Adding in -410 bps of currency pressure and a -180 bps

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| CORE

KO	OVERWEIGHT
U.S. CHPC & Beverages	NEUTRAL
Price Target	USD 68.00
Price (26-Apr-24)	USD 61.74
Potential Upside/Downside	+10.1%

U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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structural drag from refranchising in the BIG division, we look for net sales to decline -1.4%. We forecast gross margin expansion of +25 bps, driven by refranchising as underlying improvement YoY is generally offset by FX headwinds during the period. Our SG&A as a percentage of sales up 25 bps YoY to 29.3%, translating to an operating margin of 31.8%. Notably, we model part of the FX headwind to materialize in Other Expense vis-a-vis further balance sheet remeasurement, such that less than the full impact of the ~2x multiplier materializes above the line. We forecast 1Q23 EPS of \$0.69, which is 1c behind Consensus and reflects +1.4% growth YoY.

What Matters Most To Us

- Perspective on recent volume trends and KO's efforts to support steady growth
- Progress on US focus areas
- Latest perspective on FX (and particularly hyperinflationary markets) for 2024

Guidance Recap

---- 1Q24 ----

- Currency: 4% headwind to revenues; 8% headwind to EPS (based on rates as of February and inclusive of hedged positions)
- Structural: 2% headwind to comparable net revenues; 1% headwind to EPS

---- 2024 ----

- Organic revenue growth: +6-7%
- EPS growth: +4-5% (currency neutral +8-10%)
- Currency: 2-3% headwind to revenues and 4-5% headwind to earnings (both including the impact of hedged positions)
- Structural: 2-3% headwind to comparable net revenues; 4-5% headwind to EPS
- Inflation: more normalized levels of inflation (historical run-rate ~LSD)
- Tax rate: ~19.2%, not including any impact of ongoing tax litigation
- FCF: \$9.2 billion, not including any potential payments related to ongoing tax litigation
- OCF: \$11.4 billion
- Capex: \$2.2 billion

---- Long-Term Guidance ----

- Organic revenue growth +4-6%
- Comparable, FX-neutral operating income growth 6% to 8%
- Comparable, FX-neutral EPS growth +7-9%
- Adjusted free cash flow conversion 90% to 95%
- CapEx at 4.5% to 5% of net revenue
- Target of 2 to 2.5x net debt leverage

KO 1Q24 Earnings Call Details

Tuesday, April 30th @ 8:30 a.m. ET - US: 888-415-4465; International: 646-960-0140; Passcode: 6819315

As always, please feel free to call with any questions or comments.

Best,

Lauren

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Primary Stocks (Ticker, Date, Price)

The Coca-Cola Company (KO, 26-Apr-2024, USD 61.74), Overweight/Neutral, CD/CE/D/E/J/K/L/M/N

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Constellation Brands (STZ)	Coty Inc. (COTY)	Duckhorn Portfolio Inc (NAPA)

Edgewell Personal Care Company (EPC)	Energizer Holdings, Inc (ENR)	International Flavors & Fragrances (IFF)
Keurig Dr Pepper (KDP)	Kimberly-Clark Corp. (KMB)	Molson Coors Beverage Company (TAP)
Newell Brands Inc. (NWL)	ODDITY Tech Ltd. (ODD)	Olaplex Holdings, Inc. (OLPX)
PepsiCo Inc. (PEP)	Procter & Gamble (PG)	Reynolds Consumer Products (REYN)
The Coca-Cola Company (KO)	The Estée Lauder Companies (EL)	

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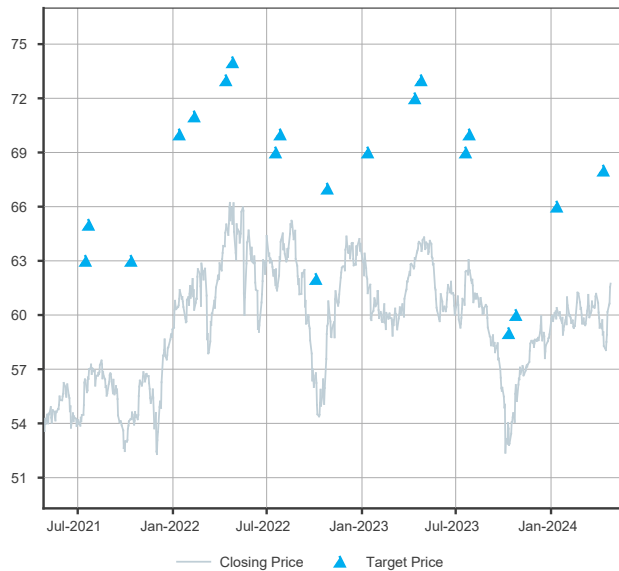
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **NEUTRAL**

Closing Price: **USD 61.74** (26-Apr-2024)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 26-Apr-2024)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
11-Apr-2024	59.72		68.00
12-Jan-2024	59.81		66.00
25-Oct-2023	55.64		60.00
11-Oct-2023	54.03		59.00
27-Jul-2023	63.05		70.00
20-Jul-2023	61.64		69.00
25-Apr-2023	63.95		73.00
13-Apr-2023	62.69		72.00
12-Jan-2023	61.21		69.00
26-Oct-2022	58.95		67.00
04-Oct-2022	56.78		62.00
27-Jul-2022	63.21		70.00
18-Jul-2022	61.65		69.00
26-Apr-2022	65.94		74.00
13-Apr-2022	64.73		73.00
11-Feb-2022	61.38		71.00
13-Jan-2022	60.90		70.00
12-Oct-2021	54.23		63.00
22-Jul-2021	56.47		65.00
16-Jul-2021	56.40		63.00

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Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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